



✂ Severity VS Priority

🏷 Tags: QA, Testing, Software Quality

🕒 Reading Time: 3 min

🚀 TL;DR (Too Long; Didn't Read)

Severity is about the technical impact (how broken is it?).

Priority is about the business urgency (how soon do we fix it?).

🤖 The Core Definitions

Mixing these two up is a common mistake. Here is how to keep them straight:

🌟 **Severity (The Technical View)**

Defined by the QA Tester.

Refers to the impact the bug has on the functionality of the software.

- Does the system crash?
- Is data lost?

- Is the user blocked from proceeding?

Priority (The Business View)

Defined by the Product Manager/Stakeholder.

Refers to how quickly the bug needs to be fixed based on business needs.

- Does it affect the brand image?
 - Are we losing money?
 - Is this feature crucial for the next release?
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The Comparison Matrix

Scenario 1: System Crash on Login

- Severity: 💥 High
- Priority: ⌚ High
- Why: Users cannot enter. The product is useless until fixed.

Scenario 2: Typo in Company Logo

- Severity: 💥 Low
- Priority: ⌚ High
- Why: Functionally fine, but it looks unprofessional and hurts the brand. Must fix NOW.

Scenario 3: Crash on IE 6 Browser

- Severity: 💥 High
- Priority: ⌚ Low
- Why: It breaks the app completely (High Severity), but almost nobody uses that browser anymore (Low Priority).

Scenario 4: Small Alignment Issue

- Severity: 💥 Low
- Priority: ⌚ Low

- Why: It looks slightly off, but everything works. We can fix it when we have time.
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💡 Real World Examples

Example 1: High Priority / Low Severity

The Scenario: On the landing page, the "Buy Now" button is neon pink instead of company red.

- Severity (Low): The button still works perfectly. The user can buy the product.
- Priority (High): Marketing is launching a campaign tomorrow. The wrong color ruins the brand consistency.

Example 2: High Severity / Low Priority

The Scenario: The application crashes if a user clicks a button 500 times in 1 minute.

- Severity (High): The application crashes (data loss potential).
- Priority (Low): No real user will ever do this behavior. We can fix this later.